

Creating Symbols

Here's where it all starts to get exciting, interesting and complicated even. When working with objects, you can make them into symbols. Graphics, buttons and movie clips are examples of Symbols

4.1 Different Types Of Symbols

There are mainly three types of symbols available in Flash CS3. These are Graphic, Button and Movie Clip symbols. Each symbol has got a unique Timeline and Stage. These symbols can be applied many a times in a document, or even in other documents.

Graphic symbols  are used for static images. Another important usage of Graphic symbol is to create reusable pieces of animation that are linked to the main Timeline. In comparison to buttons and Movie Clips, Graphic symbols contribute very little to the flash file size as they usually don't have a timeline with animation as such. These symbol functions in sync with the main Timeline.

Button symbols  on the other hand are mainly used to create interactive movies. These buttons respond to mouse clicks, rollovers and other actions.

Buttons have 4 stages. These are Up, Over, Down and Hit.



Button States

Now let us discuss these steps one by one.

Up State: This is the stage when the cursor is away from the button. The appearance of a button when placed on the screen is the Up State.

Over State: When the mouse cursor is placed over the button the appearance of the button can change. This is referred as Over State